ENTERTAINER GUIDE TO RELATIONSHIPS

Enhance romantic partnerships, friendships, and parent-child relationships

16Personalities

Table of Contents

Introduction 3
Romantic Relationships 5
Potential Personality Pairings 7
Entertainer-Analyst Relationships 8
Entertainer-Diplomat Relationships 12
Entertainer-Sentinel Relationships 15
Entertainer-Explorer Relationships 19
Conclusion 22
Friendships 23
Friendships with Other Types 24
Entertainer-Analyst Friendships 24
Entertainer-Diplomat Friendships 27
Entertainer-Sentinel Friendships 29
Entertainer-Explorer Friendships 32
Conclusion 34
Parenthood 35
Parent-Child Type Combinations 37
Entertainer Parent and an Analyst Child . . 38
Entertainer Parent and a Diplomat Child . . 39
Entertainer Parent and a Sentinel Child . . 41
Entertainer Parent and an Explorer Child. . 43
Conclusion 45
Final Words 46
So... What's Next? 47

Introduction

Why Relationships Matter to Entertainers

Gregarious and passionate, Entertainers exude a contagious enthusiasm for life that often draws others into their circle of fun. They thrive on novelty, are pleasure-seekers to the core, and take a spontaneous approach to creating the exhilarating life that they crave.

When it comes to their relationships, these Extraverted merrymakers can't help but share the beauty and pleasures of the world with the people around them. For Entertainers, this interaction with others goes well beyond the simple give-and-take of interpersonal communication – it's central to their personality.

As Extraverts, they light up the room wherever they go, drawing the spotlight with their fun, lively, and occasionally wild conversations. Entertainers love to be the center of attention and don't mind breaking the ice by leading the way onto the dance floor or picking up the mic for some impromptu karaoke. Whether it's a hip party or a family reunion, group gatherings energize Entertainers, showing them at their best: warm, passionate, and magnetic.

Curious about the traits that make up your personality type and the theory behind them? You can learn more here.

Beneath their sparkling exteriors, Entertainers care about the people around them. They're both generous and curious, showering their time and attention on those who catch their interest. Thanks to their observational skills and emotional intelligence, Entertainers can often

detect how other people feel. When they see that someone is having a hard time, they don't hold back or pretend not to notice. Instead, they're likely to ask what's wrong and how they can help.

On the romance front, Entertainers are affectionate and spontaneous – two traits that can make them irresistible. They tend to sweep their partners off their feet, introducing them to new experiences and pleasures.

But while Entertainers can be loving and sensitive, they also tend to be unpredictable. Like other Explorer personality types, they're often impulsive, which can create certain challenges once the newness and excitement of a relationship has waned.

Fortunately, Entertainers have a lot to offer in their relationships. They invigorate their partners, help their friends feel seen and cared for, and – if they become parents – teach their children just how glorious the world can be. In this e-book, we will explore how Entertainers can build the thriving, lively relationships that are central to their quality of life. We'll cover the strengths that people with this personality type bring to their romantic relationships, their friendships, and their roles as parents – as well as how they can deal with the interpersonal challenges that may threaten to get in their way. It is our hope that with the insights and guidance provided in this book, Entertainers can create and maintain the balanced relationships that they need in order to lead the rich and fulfilling lives that they desire.

Romantic Relationships

In relationships, few personality types are as enthralling and unpredictable as Entertainers. Whether platonic or romantic, people with this personality seek fun and pleasure in each moment of their relationships. Entertainers sweep their partners off their feet, lavish them with affection, and devise exciting things to do together such as hanging out in new social scenes or exploring the latest hot spots. Caring, charismatic, and emotionally attuned, Entertainers don't just make their lovers feel like the center of the world – they make the center of the world a happening place to be.

Their intense focus on the present makes it easy for these types to be in the moment and at the center of everyone's attention; however, it has its downsides. For some Entertainers, this often means they haven't learned as much from their past relationships as they could. In addition, their inability to tolerate discomfort in the present moment may make them bail when their relationships face challenges, stumbling blocks, or lulls. When it's time to change old patterns, negotiate tricky situations, and make long-term plans and commitments, Entertainers with an unbalanced approach to romance may be tempted to cut and run. From the outside, it looks as if they're devoted one moment and then disconnected the next.

Entertainers sometimes face another major challenge in their relationships: feelings. As any Entertainer may tell you, the world of feelings can be gloriously all-consuming, from desire to joy to love itself. People with this personality type give themselves over to

their emotions, experiencing their full range and potency. At times, however, emotional regulation is necessary, whether it means taking a moment to cool down during an argument or considering a criticism before defending themselves against it. This skill doesn't come easily to Entertainers, and unless they consciously develop it, they may overreact to reproaches or snags in their relationships, taking every slight – real and imagined – personally.

When they bring these traits into balance, Entertainers are generous and enthusiastic with other people. Always seeking fresh ways to express their affection and enrich their relationships, they delight in making their partners feel special. For Entertainers, ideal romance is founded on true love, simple pleasures, and plenty of romantic sparks.

Dating and the Single Entertainer

Entertainers are sociable, outgoing individuals who love to branch out and meet new people. At bars, parties, and group gatherings, they draw focus from the spotlight, making it easy to catch the eyes of potential partners. Open-minded and curious, Entertainers rarely stick to a "type." They might date a free-spirited artist, a sharp-witted scholar, or a warm-hearted doctor – all in one week.

Some Entertainers, however, are swayed by social status and outward appearances when choosing lovers. These individuals are acutely sensitive to others' opinions and find it difficult to date someone their peers might not consider a "catch." As a result, they may gravitate toward people who appear to be attractive and successful, rather than search for someone who fulfills them on a deeper level.

Fortunately, Entertainers excel at venturing into new terrain and breaking through old limits; they're perfectly capable of pushing past conventions and expectations in their search for soul mates. When they're on dates, Entertainers can tune into their true feelings by using their acute sensory awareness and observational skills. By noticing how potential partners make them feel on emotional and physical levels, these types can learn to distinguish between a relationship they truly want and a relationship that just looks good from the outside.

Entertainers in the Bedroom

Entertainers are emotionally intelligent people who also are very much in touch with the physical world. These combined qualities make them great sexual partners. Affectionate and sensual, Entertainers cultivate an easygoing, almost automatic intimacy in their romantic relationships. They appreciate what their lovers do for them, and they genuinely enjoy discovering what brings their partners' pleasure. This heightened open-mindedness extends to the bedroom, leaving Entertainers with relatively few hang-ups or insecurities regarding their sexuality.

As in other areas of their lives, Entertainers seek pleasure in the present moment, and they may feel less devoted to their partners if their sex lives plateau or fall into a rut. Novelty-seeking Entertainers may be tempted to stray or end their relationships if the spark fades. If their relationships are meaningful, however, Entertainers are more than capable of reigniting the flame. They can use their creativity to look for new ways to please themselves and their significant others, introducing novelty, play, and experimentation into even the longest standing of relationships.

Potential Personality Pairings

The Right Approach

Entertainers are typically affectionate and caring toward their partners. They know how to have a good time and delight in the moment. But they also contribute to the relationship in practical and consistent ways, proving to their sweethearts they're trustworthy and reliable. Despite their cravings for novelty, Entertainers at their best recognize when a relationship is too precious to lose.

Although romance is far from an exact science, most people with the Entertainer personality type understand that putting their best foot forward achieves the best results. With so many personality variables in play, relationships can highlight their many strengths, including their innate open-mindedness and adaptability. Relationships can also provide Entertainers with invaluable chances to learn, develop, and grow into the individuals they want to be.

The information presented in the following sections is designed to help Entertainers build and navigate successful romantic relationships. With that in mind, we'll offer a look at some of the ways they're likely to interact with other personality types. Additionally, we'll look at ways Entertainers can maximize their chances for happiness by creating fulfilling, balanced relationships with those types.

Entertainer-Analyst Relationships

In romance, opposites often attract to make their other halves complete. That potential is there when Entertainers and Analysts fall in love. More in touch with the concrete and aesthetic world, Entertainers tend to decide matters through a more emotional filter. Analysts, however, dwell in a world of ideas and theories and prefer a more rational filter. If they avoid making their differences points of contention, they're likely to find something unique and interesting with the potential for powerful lives together that neither would experience alone.

Balanced Entertainer-Analyst Relationships

Open Minds, Good Times

In the early stages of romance, Entertainers might delight in the novelty of Analysts' ideas, particularly if these ideas relate to something tangible. They may also enjoy helping Analysts break out of their serious, intellectual shells. With their carefree, inventive mindsets, Entertainers find it gratifying to introduce Analysts to new ways to kick back and have fun.

As their shared relationships progress, Entertainers often appreciate Analysts' lack of concern about conventions and traditions. Entertainers

love to try new things and embrace current trends, and they crave partners who won't hold them back in their experimentation. Analysts typically are unconcerned with standard aesthetics, and they likely won't object even when their Entertainer sweethearts gravitate toward the *avant-garde*—whether that means wearing a wild new outfit or performing an edgy song.

Entertainers also appreciate the breathing room likely to be granted by Analyst partners. Analysts go into their own mental world, needing to spend time with their ideas and theories. Entertainers may not want to go along for the ride, but they can use this time and energy to discover more about the world in their way, taking advantage of the latitude and freedom given by their Analyst partners. Nobody will ever accuse an Entertainer-Analyst pair of smothering each other.

Unbalanced Entertainer-Analyst Relationships

Mirror, Mirror

In the dating process, some Entertainers might be turned off by Analysts. All Entertainers have a highly developed aesthetic sense, but occasionally some of them can veer off into superficiality, becoming obsessed with image or appearances. These Entertainers may be embarrassed even to be seen with Analysts, who are hardly known for their sharp sense of style.

If Entertainers try to change Analysts – encouraging them to shop at trendy boutiques, for example – they're likely fighting a losing battle. Analysts have a lot of self-respect, but they rarely see the point of trying to impress other people. They won't withhold their opinions, either, and Entertainers may be criticized for focusing on appearances rather than more "important" matters.

Criticism and Contempt

In troubled Entertainer-Analyst relationships, partners don't always appreciate how their differences can serve as strengths. As their relationships progress, conversations may regularly spiral downward into criticism or even contempt. Entertainers may occasionally be hurt by Analysts' bluntness. Overly sensitive Entertainers might return fire

in ways that hurt their partners much more than they realize from the Analysts' stoic exteriors.

These conversations often follow common patterns. Because Entertainers prefer to focus on actionable matters and the present moment instead of abstractions and hypothetical scenarios, their Analyst partners might accuse them of being shallow, unimaginative, or intellectually incurious. Entertainers might also find themselves targeted for their interest in "frivolous" matters, such as fun, fashion, or receiving attention from others.

This is a two-way street, however. Entertainers may lose patience with their Analyst lovers' need to theorize about everything, which might seem stodgy, boring, or pointless to them. Given Analysts' disregard for nitty-gritty, practical matters, Entertainers may find – to their dismay – that household chores regularly fall to them when Analysts get caught up in their latest obsessions or projects. For both these partners, stress levels can escalate in tandem with domestic chaos, as laundry piles grow, and dirty dishes overfill the sink.

Although Entertainers are generally good-natured, they readily show their feelings – including, at times, their negative judgments. The resulting chronic pain and frustration on both sides may leave the roving-prone Entertainers to wonder if it's time to move on.

Rebalancing Entertainer-Analyst Relationships

Inviting Analysts Along

Rather than becoming irritated at what they perceive as their Analyst significant others' stodginess, Entertainers can encourage them to come along on one of their adventures. By inviting Analysts into their world of fun and discovery, Entertainers get a win-win: quality time with their partners and the joy of sharing good times with those they care about.

To persuade Analysts to participate in new activities, Entertainers can highlight the benefits or upsides of an adventure – whether that's taking advantage of a once-in-a-lifetime opportunity, seeing a new

artist or band before they catch on, or just gaining much-needed stress relief and the resulting health benefits. Analysts think rationally, and they allocate their time and energy accordingly. Without losing their sense of spontaneity, Entertainers can focus just enough on the *why* of an activity to interest their Analyst partners.

Outsource, Automate, Skip

As their romances progress and these two types move in together, they must find a sustainable way to manage their shared homes. Because hands-on, mundane details hold little interest for Analysts, Entertainers may end up with more than their share of household responsibilities. Entertainers may feel bogged down by chores and duties that cramp their style. They might even be tempted to blow off these responsibilities, leaving their home in a state of chaos. Although this might sound like a small matter, the division of domestic responsibilities can become a major issue in long-term relationships.

Entertainers should sit down with their partners and – tedious though it may seem – write out a list of all recurring chores, payments, and tasks. Fortunately, the next step is much more fun: identify everything that can be outsourced, automated, or skipped altogether. This may mean budgeting for a cleaning service, setting aside some time to establish recurring bill payments, or even parting with rarely used items that require regular maintenance. By taking these steps, Entertainers and their Analyst lovers can lighten their load of chores and responsibilities, leaving them more time and energy for pursuits that light them up instead.

Entertainer-Diplomat Relationships

While both base their decisions on humanistic, emotional foundations, Entertainers have a bias toward practical action, and Diplomats favor a less concrete approach. Diplomats might be at home reading books on ending poverty and dreaming of material equality in the world; Entertainers might just as likely be out pounding nails along with other Habitat for Humanity volunteers. But romances between dreamers and doers are often successful. When they fall in love, they sometimes find the dimensions their partners add are just the things they needed in their lives.

Balanced Entertainer-Diplomat Relationships

Free Spirits

When they first date, Diplomats are typically enthralled by their Entertainer partners' free spirits and enthusiasm for living in the moment. Given their curiosity about other people, Entertainers may be drawn to the unusual ways Diplomats express themselves and their almost mystical presence. These two types tend to find a fair amount of shared ground, including mutual desires for freedom and novelty. When these two types date, it can be an exciting time full of energy and anticipation.

As their shared relationships mature, Entertainers and Diplomats can bring out the best in each other. Neither type is a slave to convention, so each will likely grant the other the freedom to pursue unusual interests, seize new opportunities, and grow to their full potential. Adaptable and flexible, they can respond to unexpected challenges as a united front, weathering storms and embracing change when necessary. Over time, Entertainers may find that Diplomats deepen

and enrich their lives, helping them to identify and embrace their values without losing their free-spirited spontaneity.

Unbalanced Entertainer-Diplomat Relationships

Drama Ensues

Entertainers live in the moment, expressing themselves and their feelings readily. This can be a wonderful match for Diplomats in the early stages of romance. As time progresses and the stakes get higher, however, Entertainers may inadvertently rile Diplomats' sensitivity. They're often surprised by the extent of Diplomats' inner landscapes, including the time they spend dwelling on past issues and dreaming about the future. Unbeknownst to Entertainers, Diplomats might be mulling over week-old conversations, putting their partners on pedestals, or planning their future lives together.

When Entertainers levy a criticism – even a mild one – it can suck the wind out of Diplomats' sails, particularly if it affects their visions of the future. Given their future orientation, Diplomats might assume Entertainers are interested in pursuing long-term relationships when they're just enjoying the present moment. Diplomats' typical sensitivity can be heightened in arguments with their Entertainer sweethearts, creating a high level of drama. Entertainers with an unbalanced approach to romance might leave these issues unresolved, escaping such conversations or even bailing on their relationships altogether.

I Love You, Now Change

Independent to the core, Entertainers dislike anyone trying to change them. In unbalanced relationships, however, Diplomats – with their love of principles and possibilities – may try to turn Entertainers into idealistic, metaphysical thinkers. Over time, these Diplomats may grow tired of what they see as Entertainers' superficial need for novelty and good times.

Some Entertainers aren't immune to the temptation to change their Diplomat partners, either. As their relationships progress, they may become annoyed by Diplomats' tendency to live in their heads and dream about ways to help others instead of embracing experiences and taking practical action. Entertainers might also become frustrated

when Diplomats – particularly Introverted types – need to stay home and relax rather than go out and have a good time. Unless they learn to appreciate the differences between themselves and their partners, Entertainers may abandon relationships in search of greener pastures.

Rebalancing Entertainer-Diplomat Relationships

Ease and Plenty

In the early stages of romance, Entertainers and Diplomats can thrive on each other's spontaneous energy and love of possibilities. As time progresses, however, these relationships – like all relationships – need solid, relatively predictable foundations. If they're constantly fretting about financial issues and car maintenance, for example, these couples inevitably struggle to maintain their closeness and mutual respect.

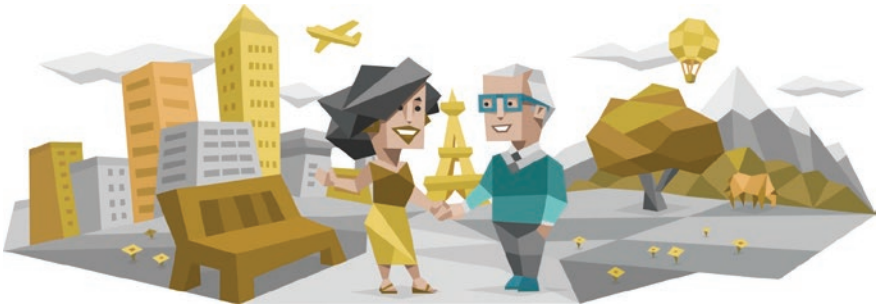
In the long run, it's also important for Entertainers and Diplomats to face financial realities. Many of these tasks can be automated or outsourced, such as automatic contributions to retirement accounts or tax planning. By taking these steps, Entertainers and their Diplomat partners can spend more time and energy on their strengths, forging strong connections rather than fretting over everyday matters.

Time Together, Time Apart

Entertainers and Diplomats might dive into relationships headlong, wanting to spend great swathes of time together. As their partnerships progress, however, they need to set aside time to pursue their individual interests. Otherwise, Entertainers may exhaust their Diplomat partners with fun outings and events, leaving Diplomats insufficient time to tend to their ideas and dreams.

By balancing time together with time apart, Entertainers and Diplomats can sidestep the need to change each other. Entertainers can venture to gallery openings, open mic nights, and parties to their hearts' delight, and Diplomats can nurture their Intuitive trait by reading, journaling, daydreaming, planning, or even setting up discussion groups or book clubs. Once they've satisfied these differing needs, Entertainers and Diplomats can then focus on spending quality time together, doing mutually enjoyable activities.

Entertainer-Sentinel Relationships



While Entertainers and Sentinels might share many of the same preferences, their contrasting Prospecting and Judging traits make all the difference. Like the rudder on a ship decides its direction, these opposing characteristics tend to turn Sentinels right and Entertainers left.

However, both these types enjoy practicality that comes with living in the "real world." Entertainer-Sentinel couples need not put up with all the theories and abstractions they might need to with Analyst or Diplomat partners. Each likes to live practical lives where they manipulate material things. In sharing this focus, these sweethearts speak the same down-to-earth language.

Balanced Entertainer-Sentinel Relationships

Practical Action

When Entertainers and Sentinels date, they discover a mutual love of quick, practical action. Thanks to the Observant trait, both types live firmly in the "here and now," focusing on life as it is rather than life as it could be.

Over time, Entertainers and Sentinels can become deeply attuned to each other. This can manifest itself even in the way they communicate. Their conversations often center on specific, actionable issues – not the future-oriented vagaries that those with the Intuitive trait favor. As a result, Entertainer-Sentinel couples can operate as effective teams, solving problems and facing challenges in real time.

Novelty and Security

When balanced, Entertainer-Sentinel couples complement each other, providing a perfect yin to the other's yang. This might surprise people, given Entertainers' love of novelty and Sentinels' love of security. It's true that Entertainers have a reputation for commitment-phobia, but, fortunately, they're unlikely to gravitate toward Sentinels until they mature and see the value of settling down. The advantages of a more stable life can help them temper the strong pull toward independence that's a hallmark of the Entertainer personality type.

During long-term relationships with Sentinels, Entertainers find support, care, and consistency – three things they may not even realize they crave. Many Entertainers weren't recognized as bright or gifted as children, and the stabilizing influence of Sentinel lovers can help Entertainers restore their sense of self-worth. Meanwhile, Entertainers get a kick out of exposing their Sentinel sweethearts to new things. Even solid Sentinels crave a little excitement in their lives – if it's not too disruptive.

Unbalanced Entertainer-Sentinel Relationships

Repetitive Roles

In the early stages of dating, Entertainers may be fascinated by the differences between themselves and their Sentinel partners. Over time, however, some Sentinel-Entertainer couples fall into roles that mimic parents and children, with Sentinels managing the responsibilities and Entertainers initiating the fun. At first, Entertainers might not mind this arrangement, but this dynamic prevents them from developing into their full potential and can spark frustration and resentment in their Sentinel partners. If their relationships progress too far in this direction, Entertainers may come to feel smothered, controlled, or even infantilized.

When Entertainers feel overpowered, they often back away from relationships. This can trigger Sentinels, who crave stability and commitment, to attempt to regain control. Some Sentinels may respond to this by redoubling their caretaking efforts, making

Entertainers feel even more trapped. All this results in tumultuous, unhappy relationships where neither type feels free to be themselves.

Commitment Mismatch

It's no secret that Entertainers tend to be less keen on commitment than Sentinels. As we've established, Entertainers might not even consider Sentinel partners until they feel ready to settle into long-term relationships. However, Sentinels make up a sizable portion of the population, so statistically, Entertainers are likely to encounter them in the dating pool.

In some challenged Entertainer-Sentinel relationships, Entertainers might feel pushed to make commitments or major decisions, such as defining their relationships or moving in together before they feel ready. They may also feel as if their Sentinel partners are needy or clingy. Meanwhile, Entertainers might struggle to understand or validate their Sentinel partners' natural need for commitment and stability.

Even in other areas of their romance, this disjointedness between Entertainers' Prospecting trait and Sentinels' Judging trait can create tension. Entertainers' spontaneity and changeability can cause stress for their Sentinel partners, who rely on tradition and predictability to feel grounded. Entertainers might not understand why their lovers worry so much about trying new restaurants or changing travel plans at the last minute. Over time, Sentinels' resistance to change can wear on Entertainers, making them feel trapped or confined.

Rebalancing Entertainer-Sentinel Relationships

Appreciation and Affirmation

In relationships with Sentinels – or any personality type, for that matter – it's important for Entertainers to stay true to themselves. When these types feel trapped or stifled, they may indulge their instinct to move on and seek new relationships. Even if Entertainers aren't ready to commit to major transitions such as marriage, they can still offer their partners reassurance and support. This is especially important with Sentinel partners, who, although they rarely ask for it, thrive on recognition and praise.

Entertainers can set themselves the goal of expressing appreciation for their Sentinel partners daily. This can be a verbal thank-you or compliment, but it doesn't have to be. Entertainers' concrete, spontaneous natures can be an asset here. They can stay on the lookout for creative ways to validate and appreciate their partners – whether it's writing a song for them or treating them to a date night they'll love. When Sentinels receive these consistent affirmations, they can relax, making them less likely to control or smother their Entertainer partners with attention.

R-E-S-P-E-C-T

In unbalanced Entertainer-Sentinel relationships, Sentinels end up taking on nearly all of the household responsibilities. Unbeknownst to Entertainers, their Sentinel sweeties may also keep score in their minds, noting all the ways they do more than Entertainers to keep things running smoothly. The result, unfortunately, is resentment and contempt – not exactly the ingredients for happy relationships.

The solution to this situation is respect: both self-respect and respect for romantic partners. Entertainers, at their best, recognize when the scales of responsibility are tilted too far in their partners' direction. In this situation, Entertainers spot that they're capable of helping out more – a hallmark of self-respect. They then respectfully ask their partners how they can better help out. Entertainers can ask targeted, concrete questions, such as:

- "What tasks do you find the most burdensome?"
- "I have a free hour, so what can I tackle to allow you some time to do what you want?"
- "Are there any chores or errands that we can do together?"

In balanced long-term relationships, both types make consistent contributions, demonstrating their care by sharing responsibilities.

Entertainer-Explorer Relationships

Balanced Entertainer-Explorer Relationships

Someone to explore with – at least, that's what one might assume is the draw when Entertainers fall in love with other Explorers. But even such a match made in heaven can have nooks and crannies that make them less than perfect under the right circumstances. The Observant and Prospecting combination produces much energy and movement and, when multiplied in a couple, can be exciting. But doubling this characteristic in romantic relationships can also be a drain and subject it to unstable impulsivity. Both types need to understand what commitment means to them and be honest with each other.

Smooth Sailing

Old saws would have us believe that "opposites attract," as though the human heart were the pole of a magnet. Fortunately, no two people are exactly alike, even if they share the same basic personality traits. There are social and environmental adaptations and nuances that prevent relationships between Explorer types from being the same as looking into a mirror. There can be plenty of the differences that keep relationships interesting – even between individuals of the same type.

In the early stages of such relationships, Entertainers may be exhilarated to be with others who share their craving for novelty. When Explorer types come together romantically, the emphasis is on playful, exciting experiences. Spending time together, they may feel even more alive than usual, creating a flirtatious, vibrant, almost electric energy between them. Because they often share similar views on commitment, Entertainers and other Explorer types can enjoy the moment fully without having mismatched expectations about the future.

As their love progresses, such couples can maintain flexibility not seen among any other paired types. Their partnerships are founded on the "here and now," and any storms in these relationships tend to pass quickly. Entertainer-Explorer couples sometimes engage in heated exchanges, but they don't hold grudges. As a result, their occasional arguments don't compromise the foundation of their shared relationships.

Big Moves, Lasting Adventures

During the dating phase, Entertainers and other Explorers may orchestrate large romantic gestures designed to "wow" their partners. When the mood strikes them, they go big: skywriting, lavish gifts, impromptu vacations, and so on. As their romances progress, these impulses might become less frequent, but balanced Entertainer-Explorer couples still try at times to sweep each other off their feet.

Even as their relationships mature, there are plenty of opportunities for these couples to share novel experiences. To stay connected, Entertainers and their Explorer partners can pursue common interests in arts, crafts, and even business. They can also integrate and expand their social circles in harmony, enjoying contact with all sorts of interesting people. In balanced Entertainer-Explorer romances, couples continue to embark on shared journeys even as the decades tick by. Such bonding of interests can provide creative stimulation and strong partnerships that last a lifetime.

Unbalanced Entertainer-Explorer Relationships

Conquests and Capriciousness

Explorers are perhaps the most mercurial types when it comes to romance. They may play the field as long as they can, resisting being "tied down" in favor of the chase. Some Explorers bounce from partner to partner, looking for fulfillment in novelty and new conquests. They leave unfinished business in their wake, sometimes breaking off relationships without even trying to explain why.

At some point, usually with age, many Entertainers and other Explorers settle down. However, they don't always date with such long-term plans in mind. Their decision to commit may be spontaneous and almost

impulsive. When romance includes not one but two Explorers, it's easy to see how their relationships can be intense and unpredictable. Both types might enter their relationships intending to live in the moment and see where it goes, but if one type becomes attached and craves more of a commitment, they may end up deeply hurt or disappointed.

Burnout

In the early stages of dating, Entertainer-Explorer couples might feel giddy about all the things they can experience together: travel, adventure, sports, parties, art exhibits, restaurants, bars, and so on. Alas, even the most energetic Explorers can only bear such intensity for so long before it becomes too much.

Over time, Entertainer-Explorer couples may tire of expending so much energy and experiencing so much excitement. They might not realize this is the issue, however. Instead, they might attribute their feelings of burnout to their relationships, concluding that their partners are responsible for their loss of enthusiasm and *joie de vivre*.

Rebalancing Entertainer-Explorer Relationships

Downtime and Stability

Although it runs counter to their natures, Entertainer-Explorer couples experiencing burnout need to cultivate stability and downtime in their lives. To do this, they can minimize needless stress by automating and outsourcing routine tasks and responsibilities. They might also plan to spend time at home regularly – for example, one or two nights per week. By dedicating this time to recharging their figurative batteries, they can experience their relationships without distractions and stimuli from the outside world. They might even sweeten these evenings at home by establishing quiet traditions, such as watching movies or cooking new dishes together.

It's also important for these couples to give each other some space. It's perfectly fine if one partner wants to go to an art opening and the other wants to have dinner with a friend. If they still nurture some of their shared interests and embark on adventures together, Entertainer-Explorer relationships may actually be strengthened by occasional time apart.

Remembering Why They Fell in Love

The honeymoon phase of a romantic relationship may be sweet, but it isn't sustainable. Over time, even devoted couples can feel restless. Some Entertainers may be tempted to give up on relationships almost on a whim, to the extent that they lose sight of what drew them to their partners in the first place.

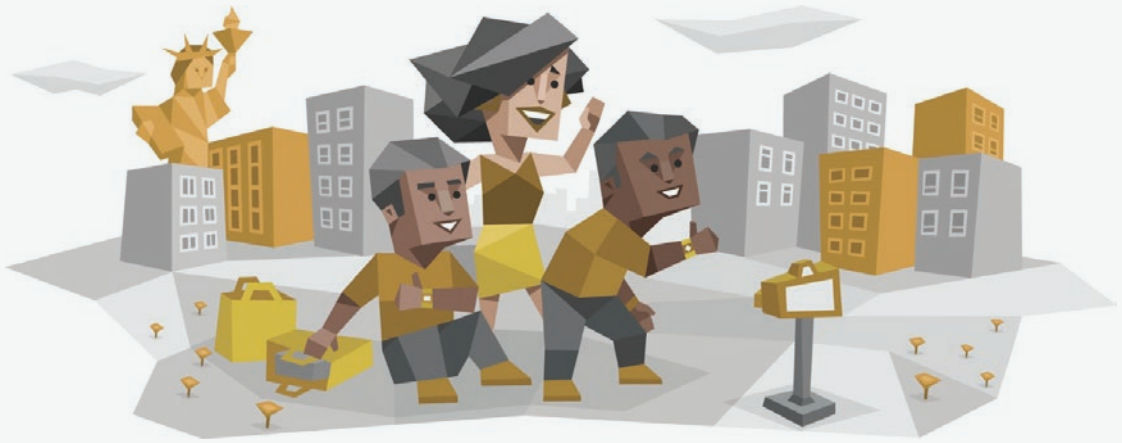
It's helpful for Entertainers to remember *why* they fell in love. Before giving up on their relationships, they might want to sit down and write a list of all the qualities that initially appealed to them about their partners. These should be qualities that the partners still embody – for example, their intelligence, their honesty, or their wit.

Entertainers who struggle to remember their partners' good qualities might try looking through old photos, recalling the details of their first dates, or even chatting with a few friends to see what they remember. After drawing up this list, Entertainers might be moved by how many strengths and gifts their partners bring to the relationship. If they'd like, Entertainers can share this list with their partners, but it's fine for them to keep this list as a private reminder of why they fell in love.

Conclusion

Relationships present Entertainers with wonderful opportunities to grow. Normally, people with this personality type feel tempted to bounce from option to option, but love can give them powerful motivation to explore the full range of life with a significant other. This won't happen overnight, but motivated Entertainers can fully harmonize their desire for novelty with the demands of a well-adjusted relationship, appreciating the inspiration and guidance they can gain from someone they love and trust. Dedicated partners not only brighten Entertainers' days but also offers them a wellspring of care and support.

In balanced relationships, Entertainers push for positive change, enabling both their partners and themselves to reach higher and do more than they could alone. When their relationships are founded on acceptance, honesty, and respect, there's no reason Entertainers can't enjoy lasting and balanced love with any personality type.



Friendships

Enthusiastic Friends

As the name may imply, Entertainers are likely to be the life of the party. With an enviable imagination and invigorating sense of spontaneity, people with the Entertainer personality type are rarely boring. They love exploring interesting ideas, both in discussion and by experiencing things for themselves, and Entertainers always seem to have fun activities hidden up their sleeves. They also are easygoing, tolerant, and charming people, which naturally makes them popular.

Entertainers thrive when they have ample opportunities to dazzle the crowd. They typically get along with just about everyone and generally make new friends wherever they go. As a naturally confident personality type (especially the Assertive among them), Entertainers live in the moment with little concern for what others think of them. This trait attracts friends who share their attitude and zest for life.

Entertainers aren't opposed to long philosophical discussions. But they're unlikely to develop friendships around one-on-one conversations about European economic challenges or the role of religion in politics. Debating over the sociopolitical atmosphere *can* be fun and stimulate their intellect. However, for Entertainers, it doesn't compare to going out and enjoying the craziness of life. For them, life is a party. These people of action prefer to perform rather than talk about the future. The bane of their existence is sitting idle, especially in boredom.

Anyone who befriends these types can expect relationships focused on exploration, excitement, adrenaline, and risk. Entertainers are happy performing for the crowd, but they also tend to encourage their friends to join in. Most personality types might take "Thanks, but no thanks," to such invitations personally, but Entertainers are comfortable with themselves and are likely to shrug their shoulders and move on to those friends who are game for adventure.

Friendships with Other Types

Entertainers are popular, as their open-mindedness, interesting hobbies, and relaxed attitude are attractive to a remarkably broad range of personality types. With so many acquaintances, Entertainers are sure to strike up deeper friendships with at least a few.

Let's examine the challenges and joys that Entertainers are likely to face in friendships with other people belonging to each of the major Roles – Analysts, Diplomats, Sentinels, and Explorers. We'll look at some ways Entertainers can balance their traits to make their friendships more valuable, fair, and fulfilling.

Entertainer-Analyst Friendships

Friends who come from different perspectives are sometimes the best friends to have. When Entertainers (Observant and Feeling) befriend Analysts (Intuitive and Thinking), their balance and counterbalance can be sublime. Entertainers bring spontaneity and passion, and Analysts offer ideas and insights, with each contributing to potentially rich, multidimensional friendships.

Balanced Entertainer-Analyst Friendships

Combining Strategy and Action

The best thing about having Analyst friends is that they can act as rational, insightful, and strategically-minded advisors for highly practical and sometimes impatient Entertainers. Analysts pride themselves in being objective, even with their closest confidants. Friends belonging to this Role would have few qualms about criticizing Entertainers' latest ideas or specific actions.

Being direct themselves, Entertainers are likely to feel at home with Analysts' approach – if their criticism isn't too harsh or too personal. Analysts' penchant for conceptual thinking may frustrate Entertainers. However, they may eventually appreciate the value of having capable friends willing to look at things from a different perspective.

Entertainers and Analysts also share a desire for efficiency. If the topic is right, otherwise distracted Entertainers may spend hours tinkering with systems or polishing techniques. With Analyst trying to understand the principles behind the functionality, and Entertainers experimenting with the concrete aspects, such partnerships can be mutually rewarding. Their principles and perspectives may not necessarily overlap, but there should be enough common ground for both types to benefit from opportunities to share their thoughts with each other.

Unbalanced Entertainer-Analyst Friendships

Tangible versus Conceptual

Entertainers and Analysts have their fair share of differences and may experience tension in their friendships as a result. The most important difference between them is the way these types absorb information.

Entertainers are grounded, live-in-the-moment individuals. For them, the real and tangible things matter most. Analysts take pleasure in coming up with various concepts and ideas, focusing primarily on what they imagine and deduce. There are ways to combine the two approaches – for instance, while working on a project that requires

both planning and execution. But these two thinking styles may turn out to be a major barrier to communication and mutual understanding.

Another important difference is that, unlike Entertainers, Analyst types usually find it difficult to emotionally support their friends. Analysts can have strong feelings, but they're neither comfortable with, nor experienced in, coping with other people's emotions. If Entertainers aren't familiar with such a trait, it may surprise or even hurt them.

Analyst friends may find it difficult to develop emotional connections. This would likely be difficult for Entertainers who enjoy – and are typically accustomed to – sharing their feelings and developing strong support networks among friends. Entertainers shouldn't take it personally, though, as Analysts are notorious for their focus on logic and rationality – it doesn't matter whose company they're in.

Rebalancing Entertainer-Analyst Friendships

Focusing on Common Ground

While these types may have drastically different ways of exploring, expressing creativity, and thinking about the future, they can rely on their common pragmatism to resolve any differences they have. One characteristic that Entertainers share with Analysts is an appreciation of effectiveness – they both love seeing practical solutions functioning efficiently. This shared appreciation isn't limited to technical areas but also applies to the social realm. For both types, particularly in matters of pure preference (where to eat, for example), it's only practical to compromise occasionally. Such compromise can be the glue that holds their shared friendships together.

When Entertainers and Analysts experience serious friction with each other, both can dial down their sense of superiority and instead focus on finding practical solutions. Resolving their differing methods and preferences can be as easy as opening their minds to the merits of the each other's perspective and trying each other's ideas. Telling friends they're wrong about something only carries hurtful judgement. However, showing them a better way is a respectful approach that both types can handle.

Entertainer-Diplomat Friendships

When Entertainers befriend Diplomats, there's likely to be a warmth that their interest in other people engenders. Both are passionate in their own way. Entertainers prefer hands-on expressions of their enthusiasm while, in contrast, Diplomats prefer ideas and dreams. If they become friends, it's likely because they value each other's approach to life from the moment they meet. Despite any differences, passion and warmth are the characteristics they have in common.

Balanced Entertainer-Diplomat Friendships

Differences That Inspire

Entertainers can find close Diplomat friends to be very rewarding and very perplexing. They may find each other confusing and mysterious at times. However, they also might come to enjoy their different points of view and the benefits they offer. Both types share an open-mindedness that allows them to at least consider the validity of another angle.

Diplomats are enthusiastic, passionate, and imaginative individuals. This energy is likely to inspire Entertainers, especially initially, perhaps even giving them exciting new ideas to follow. Diplomats are rare compared to other personality types, and their unusual thinking may be very intriguing to Entertainers. However, that fascination may also include confusion – just like Analysts, Diplomats primarily live in their minds, and this attitude can be foreign to practical-minded, hands-on Entertainers.

Regardless of these issues, Entertainer-Diplomat friendships can be quite inspiring. Empathic and insightful, Diplomats can pull more

realistic Entertainers away from their daily concerns, encouraging them to develop their thoughts and ideas. Diplomats tend to have a knack for making people feel relaxed and comfortable, and restless Entertainers can really profit from such company.

Idealistic and often absent-minded Diplomats also benefit from friendship with highly practical and efficiency-oriented Entertainers. People with the Entertainer personality type put their ideas into action, and this amazes Diplomats, motivating them to do the same with their own dreams. As rewarding as brainstorming potentially is, there's often just no substitute for some positive shared experiences.

Unbalanced Entertainer-Diplomat Friendships

Very Different Priorities

Both types are likely to share a certain excitement about discovering and experiencing new things, although what they define as interesting is likely to be different. Despite this similarity, however, they may also remain enigmas to each other on some level. Diplomats' nearly constant soul-searching is as meaningful to them as experiencing things is to Entertainers. These differences can lead to numerous misunderstandings.

Another issue Entertainers and their Diplomat friends may come across is their shared tendency to neglect day-to-day matters and necessities. Whether Entertainers decide to go on unplanned road trips a week before tax returns are due, or distracted Diplomat roommates forget to transfer the rent money, both types must sometimes deal with unpleasant surprises – especially if such matters affect them both. Although meticulousness isn't always their strong suit, both Entertainers and Diplomats must pay attention to their mutual responsibilities.

Rebalancing Entertainer-Diplomat Friendships

Taking Time to Help Each Other

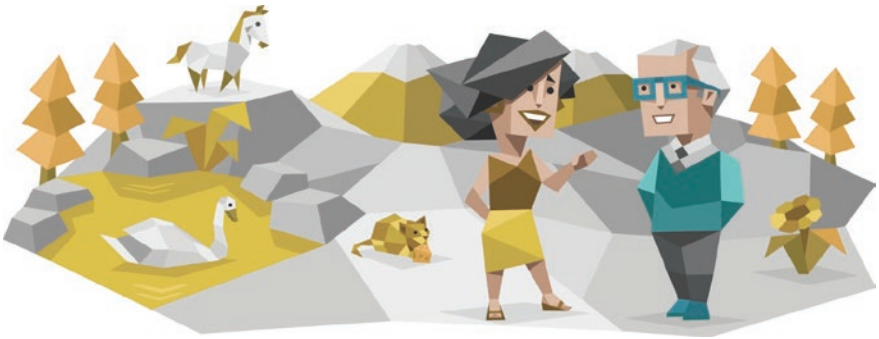
These types may not be perfectly compatible when it comes to their

day-to-day routines. They may, however, find that they enhance the richness of each other's lives when balanced with a little flexibility.

Diplomats maintain a kind of remarkable, principled sincerity that can beautifully balance Entertainers' sometimes-cynical approach to life. With Diplomat friends, Entertainers can connect to social rewards that come from thinking more broadly than just about what directly affects their lives. Entertainers are always seeking exciting challenges and may unwittingly pass right by warmer human connections as a result. But, with Diplomat friends by their side, even such energetic and logical types find time to stop and smell the roses.

Despite their neglectful attitudes toward the mundane parts of everyday life, they can provide balance for each other's respective weaknesses. When it's time to focus on necessities all too dull and ordinary for these types to enjoy, their friendship itself can provide the missing element of amusement. Even the most mundane, uninspired tasks, such as doing chores and running errands, can turn into fun adventures when these friends get together. They can offer each other company, amusing outlooks, and interesting conversation.

Entertainer-Sentinel Friendships



Entertainers and Sentinels may look very similar glancing at the personality type letters, but what a difference a single letter can make. Where Entertainers are spontaneous, Sentinels foster stability. Where Entertainers are pragmatists not always concerned with the rules, Sentinels uphold every jot and tittle of established standards. Luckily, these differences, however pronounced, don't necessarily make friendship between the two types impossible. There's much potential when these opposites attract.

Balanced Entertainer-Sentinel Friendships

Everyday Companions

Sentinels are numerous and probably make up a significant part of Entertainers' social circles unless they're particularly selective. These personality types are likely to be loyal, practical, and down-to-earth friends, always eager to offer advice and support. Sentinel friends can help Entertainers stay focused and realistic when necessary, and their patience, stability, and devotion can be invaluable in situations where Entertainers feel confused or uncertain about their constantly shifting paths.

Both Entertainers and Sentinels tend to be highly practical, with their feet planted firmly on the ground. Both types are likely to focus on activities that engage their senses: sports, going on a hike, or working on a tangible project together may be among them. More freewheeling Entertainers might add to their friendships by convincing Sentinels to let go of their serious attitudes and simply have fun occasionally. For their part, Sentinels can counterbalance Entertainers' occasional devil-may-care approach by helping them structure their lives a bit more.

Unbalanced Entertainer-Sentinel Friendships

Clashing Senses of Responsibility

The main point of contention in Entertainer-Sentinel friendships is likely to be their different understanding of freedom and individualism. Entertainers are famous for their unyielding spirit of independence. They often see rules and traditions as stifling and redundant limitations. To them, freedom of expression is more important than social cohesion or security.

On the other hand, Sentinels scoff at the thought of someone ignoring social conventions just for the sake of individualism – from their perspective, stability and security are topmost concerns. These types are likely to argue that the needs of the many outweigh the needs of the few. These differences may lead to some heated discussions revolving around flexibility and responsibility.

Rebalancing Entertainer-Sentinel Friendships

Truly Respecting Differences

There's little these types can do to rebalance friction in their shared friendships unless they're both willing to acknowledge the virtues of the other's perspective. This doesn't mean they must adopt those viewpoints as their own, but there's a chance they can bridge their differences simply by recognizing that different lifestyles can work for different people.

Entertainers can appreciate how Sentinels enjoy the sense of security that low-risk stability brings. They might also learn to respect that what may seem limited or restricted in the short term to them may be necessary for strong, long-term success for their Sentinel chums. In turn, Sentinels can appreciate that while a spontaneous, risk-taking approach may not be for them, Entertainers can – and do – make it work for their own lives. Sentinels can view their Entertainer friends with supportive amazement instead of dismay – knowing that, win or lose, they'll likely pick themselves up and begin anew.

These friends also do well to accept a degree of input from each other, as they may both be highly capable in their own ways, and equally able to give each other some balance. Sentinels who learn to take measured risks by following in the path of Entertainer friends undoubtedly increase their opportunities in life. And, Entertainers who listen to the wise advice of Sentinel friends may sidestep some of their own worst mistakes.

Entertainer-Explorer Friendships

"Live for the moment" is the likely motto for Entertainers who strike up friendships with other Explorers. The exhilaration of such spontaneous and active relationships is likely to be heady for both. These individuals are likely asked to conform and slow down in many areas of their lives. Such shared friendships are likely a respite from the demands of others. However, there's no perfect friendship – and even this seemingly seamless match has hazards to avoid.

Balanced Entertainer-Explorer Friendships

Lively Compatibility

For Entertainers, having close Explorer friends is a bit like looking into a mirror. Because Explorers are practical and inventive individuals, it's unlikely that such friends will ever run out of things to do. All Explorers prefer to bond over shared activities, so it's common for them to push each other to explore new hobbies or immerse themselves more into existing ones. They also are likely to find it easy to maintain their camaraderie, regardless of any difficulties that may develop.

Even though free-thinking Entertainers and other Explorer types are bound to have minor differences as friends, it's likely they feel as if they've found a true mind-mate in each other. Spontaneous, bold, and willing to push limits, they're typically fun and interesting friends who provide each other with plenty of bonding opportunities.

Unbalanced Entertainer-Explorer Friendships

Shared Chaos

A key challenge for Entertainer and Explorer friends likely comes from the same source that fuels their friendship: their similarities. Having friends who are like-minded can be fun and reassuring, but it can also result in creating a bubble, isolating them from criticism and growth. There's a risk that they may convince each other that their behavior and attitude are fine, even if they need to address obvious issues – such as dealing with monotonous, yet essential, tasks.

Another issue that Entertainer-Explorer friends may face is the likelihood of both placing more importance on tangible things rather than imagination and mental exercises. It may be good to encourage each other to find time for intellectual growth and discussions about the future. If Entertainer-Explorer friends fail to stop and think about the long-term picture occasionally, problems can arise.

Rebalancing Entertainer-Explorer Friendships

Embracing New Ideas Together

Entertainers and other Explorers tend to be very open. One way for these friends to avoid being limited by their similarities is to tap into that openness and bring dissimilar kinds of friends into their circle. Entertainers are great at figuring out how unusual pieces fit together and can apply this cleverness to social relationships. Seeking new friends with different viewpoints – people from other Role groups, for example – can be an exciting adventure filled with possibilities.

Including diverse people in their social group can help these friends develop beyond just living for the moment and reaping those immediate pleasures. They can expand into being better strategic thinkers, productive dreamers, and responsible doers. Entertainers and other Explorers all benefit from friendships that encourage them to take an occasional fresh approach to things, balancing out their focus on immediate desires.

Such friends may find that not only does this make their lives more secure, but it also enables them to plan and experience new adventures together. Forethought can open even more amazing opportunities than spontaneity can because it allows these friends to inject some of their own preferences into an outcome – instead of just making do with whatever ends up happening.

Conclusion

Entertainers are energetic Extraverts and that generally means they value outreach and gain some of their energy from their friends. Their bias toward action is likely to bring an extra measure of vigor into the lives of those they befriend, and their practical creativity tends to broaden or shift their friends' perspectives. Such exciting friendships with unique Entertainers are often things to treasure.

Entertainers are likely to be more anchored and more balanced because of the influence of these friendships. If they find someone who shares their interest, such a partner in crime to bounce ideas and schemes off of is likely to be prized. They may have to give up some of the independence they hold so dear, but the tradeoff may be well worth it.

Parenthood

Relaxed and Fun-Loving

Entertainers are some of the most relaxed, fun-loving parents out there. They genuinely enjoy playing with their children and are constantly devising new and exciting ways to spend their time together. From the first moment they hold their babies, Entertainers are taken with the joy and wonder their children experience in everything around them, sharing and encouraging it as much as possible.

Exploration and experiences are key philosophies for Entertainer parents. When their children ask a question, these parents' answer is likely some variation of, "Let's find out!" Overbearing structures and tightly scheduled activities aren't a major part of their parenting style. They'd rather let things unfold day-by-day and let their kids explore life in their own way. This doesn't mean rules don't exist at all – Entertainers are also practical. Nonetheless, their parenting style reflects their approach to living.

People with this personality aren't the most demanding parents. But Entertainers are likely to provide plenty of emotional support. Due mostly to their warm affection and innate practicality, they take on a nurturing and encouraging parenting style which can fill in many gaps left by their more casual approach.

Entertainers might happily build make-believe spaceships when their children declare themselves future astronauts – and then imaginatively use those declarations later when it's time to focus on schoolwork and goals. After all, successful astronauts must know their math!

Difficulty with Discipline

Discipline is far from Entertainers' strongest suit as parents. Nonetheless, they typically use hindsight and maturity to create standards that prevent their children from suffering the same hurts and setbacks that they themselves experienced. These parents don't typically instill many rules, but when they do, Entertainers are sensitive people and expect their children to respect and obey those put in place. Unsurprisingly, this can prove to be a point of contention during the teenage years.

Additionally, some Entertainers may be so interested in maintaining the image of "cool" parents that they fail to create or enforce rules for their children. Acting like friends rather than parents is a romantic concept, but the ramifications of this lack of structure and discipline can have long-term negative consequences.

Specifically, children raised in this dynamic are likely to feel entitled to the same treatment from other adults in their lives. Their teachers and friends' parents may react negatively to children who insist on being treated as equals. Entertainer parents who act as "friends" are also less likely to earn their children's respect, and it may be difficult to put down rules once they establish such a buddy relationship with their kids.

Providing Support and Structure

Although it may not come naturally, Entertainers must provide some structure, including discipline, for their children. Using what comes naturally to them – namely their sensitivity and excellent people skills – they can provide the support their kids need in warm and loving ways. Meanwhile, Entertainers can balance this by clearly communicating the rationale for the rules they enforce. This creates a blend of parental responsibility and the traits that make Entertainer parents unique. They need not become someone else to be good parents.

Discipline is a tricky topic for all parents, especially those who must feel "liked" by their kids, but children are more likely to appreciate their parents if they're given a clear set of boundaries and expectations. Fun can be had. However, fun can be more rewarding for both parents and children within consistent and loving boundaries that make

kids feel safe. While they often won't admit it, kids need structure, and they naturally look to their parents for it – including fun-loving Entertainer parents.

Parent-Child Type Combinations

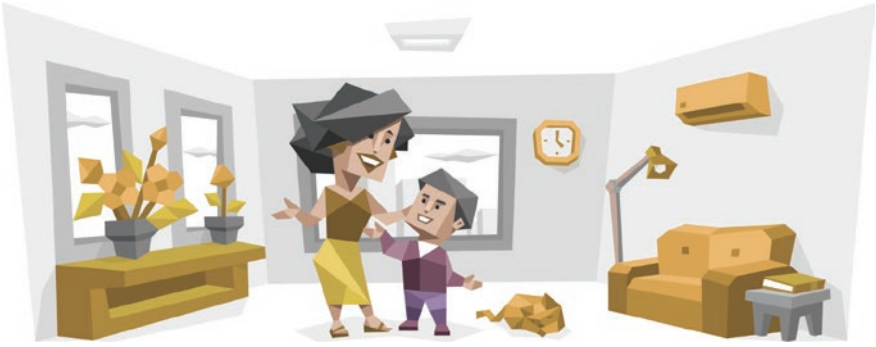
Using personality types to define children is an interesting proposition. While most see personality as something at least partly genetic and inherent, those influences may only lightly touch a child or only be softly apparent during childhood.

Childhood is about experimenting, learning, and adapting. This means their behavior is often exploratory rather than permanently defining. There may be hints of a personality type, but with so much adapting going on, it may be hard to pinpoint their consistent traits exactly. And since children aren't self-aware enough to take a personality test, they don't have the same advantages as adults who can answer questions describing their preferences.

Therefore, when we talk about the Analyst child, for example, we are referring mainly to children who demonstrate a preference for a rational approach, even if the preference is sporadic and uncertain. But we urge caution toward labeling children until they're older and can express their preferences themselves. The job of childhood is discovery. We advocate giving them a chance to explore on their own and in their own time without pigeonholing them in a personality cubby.

But for the sake of discussion, we describe things that Entertainers may want to take note of when parenting children who engage in certain trait behaviors. We do so without presuming these behaviors are either permanent or a temporary phase. We urge readers to do so as well.

Entertainer Parent and an Analyst Child



Curious and Open-Minded

Analyst-leaning children tend to be intellectual, curious, and imaginative. Their creativity and open-mindedness are likely to please their Entertainer parents, who may be intrigued by their children's willingness to explore the unknown and pleased by the similarity to their own penchant for improvisation.

Entertainers and Analysts share an interest in uncovering how things work, which is why these parents have few problems with communication or coming up with interesting activities. Analyst kids also tend to strongly focus on and pursue the things that catch their interest. Entertainer parents may delight in this common trait. It likely thrills them to see their children acting in similarly determined ways.

Practical Parent versus Theoretical Child

The core engines that drive exploration and curiosity are different in Entertainers and Analysts. Entertainers usually enjoy exploring things simply because they present a challenge, choosing afterward to either move on to something more interesting or spend time honing their skills in that area. Like other Explorers, Entertainers focus on the tangible and the real. In contrast, Analysts primarily work from an intellectual perspective, trying to understand the hidden principles, systems, and patterns behind things, even when that offers few tangible benefits.

Analyst children may question their Entertainer parents' suggestions or conclusions simply because they're interested in connecting with their parents' thought process. It isn't necessarily because they don't trust them or that they doubt them. Such questions may frustrate

some Entertainers, who are likely to see them as a waste of time. "Less thinking and more doing," might be their initial reaction. Entertainer parents who offer statements like, "Because it works," or "Because this is the best way," aren't likely to persuade their Analyst kids.

Finding Shared Interests

Analyst children tend to require minimal emotional support, which probably seems rather strange for kind, sensitive Entertainers. Analysts often hide and rationalize their feelings and, as Intuitive types, enjoy their own brand of being independent. Entertainer parents can appreciate their Analyst children's need for independence and can be supportive of their desire for rational communication over emotional interaction, but problems can arise when there is a genuine need to discuss something of an emotional nature. Entertainer parents may need to find ways other than heartfelt conversations to bond with their Analyst children.

Entertainer Parent and a Diplomat Child

Inquisitive and Creative

Although they share some traits in common, Entertainers and Diplomats are also opposite in multiple ways. Both possess inquisitive natures. Both show a willingness to explore. Both have an inborn desire for freedom and creativity. However, Entertainers also tend to have an excellent grasp of reality, an impressive arsenal of practical skills, and an uncanny ability to focus in the present moment. These aren't typically part of Diplomats' go-to characteristics and may not resonate with Diplomat children who tend to detach from the practical world.

Diplomat kids can typically find something to focus on, even without help from their families. Although this is likely to please Entertainer

parents, they should monitor these activities to ensure their children have enough mental stimulation. Diplomats are idealistic and even somewhat poetic individuals, characteristics that may baffle Entertainers. As an example, Entertainer parents may simply see planting trees as a fun, physical exercise. Meanwhile, their Diplomat children may be fantasizing about what would happen if everyone in their city did the same.

Impulsive versus Idealistic

Diplomat children, like Entertainers, tend to value personal responsibility and the need to make their own decisions. But Entertainer parents should be careful to separate this from their own tendency to experiment and push limits. Diplomats typically seek to develop strong inner principles and to pick noble, often too idealistic goals and may respond better to arguments based on values and principles rather than rewards and practical benefits.

This aspect is likely to create any tension there may be between Entertainer parents and Diplomat children. Entertainers tend to be very selective in their interests and show little patience for things outside of a specific category. However, their Diplomat kids prefer to dive deeply in an attempt to uncover something fascinating about almost everything they encounter. Entertainer parents may need to at least feign interest in their children's musings or find some way to channel their imagination into real-world experiences.

Accepting and Encouraging Differences

Entertainer parents should remember that their Diplomat children require a different approach compared to what's natural for them. Further, they shouldn't attempt to "fix" their children's idealism or occasional naïveté. Entertainer parents should try instead to appreciate (and learn from) their children's enthusiasm, open-mindedness, and creativity. Diplomats' abilities are often underappreciated and rejected as offering little practical value. A little encouragement from their families can go a long way.

Such issues are even more important during the teenage years. Thankfully, Entertainers are nonconformists themselves and are,

therefore, unlikely to criticize their teens' habits or push them to look for more conventional career paths. Instead, Entertainers are likely to encourage their Diplomat teenagers to pursue something that inspires and motivates them, and then help them along the way.

Entertainer Parent and a Sentinel Child

A Practical and Perceptive Pair

Entertainers share the Observant trait with their Sentinel-leaning children, so communication is relatively uncomplicated between these parents and children. Both types focus on practicality and facts. They prefer to leave theoretical and abstract conversations to Intuitive Analysts and Diplomats. Expectations tend to be straightforward, and Sentinel kids are likely to know exactly where they stand with their parents.

The Observant trait also effects how these types experience their environment. Both Entertainer parents and Sentinel children are perceptive and focus on what's happening around them in the moment. Most Entertainers notice even subtle changes in their children's behavior, allowing them to respond quickly and efficiently to prevent situations from escalating to unmanageable levels.

Not Enough Structure

Sentinel kids are likely to be obedient, trying hard to meet their parents' expectations. They respect family hierarchy and traditional roles, relying on their parents to set up a structured environment with well-defined rules. Sentinels don't like to discover what's acceptable through trial and error the way Entertainers do, and they prefer an up-front and clear understanding of what is and isn't okay. Entertainers

rarely share their Sentinel children's orderly view of the world. But these parents typically appreciate their children's willingness to cooperate and to listen to them.

Additionally, Sentinel children seek a safe and stable atmosphere above all else. Spontaneity and fun are secondary to these needs. Entertainers should recognize these different priorities and remember that their Sentinel children are likely to be far more careful, traditional, and methodical in their exploration of the world. In certain situations, the somewhat *laissez-faire* parenting style some Entertainers embrace may not be ideal for these structure-seeking children.

Respecting the Need for Stability

Sentinel children need stability to build trusting relationships with their parents. They desire consistency and structure more than any other personality type, and they struggle with parents who don't provide this type of environment for them. Although they thrive on spontaneity and adventure, Entertainer parents must modify their behavior to best meet the needs of their children, especially in their early years. From keeping a consistent feeding schedule to creating a bedtime routine, Entertainers can establish the sense of security and dependability that their Sentinel children crave.

It's also important for Entertainers to respect their kids' aversion to risk-taking. Sentinels aren't a thrill-seeking type. They're less likely to be interested in riding a roller coaster or trying new foods. Although they certainly can benefit from moving outside of their comfort zone occasionally, it's important to do this slowly and with their approval. Breaking Sentinel children's trust is one of the most harmful mistakes these parents can make.

Entertainer parents may need to start gradually and be patient. Add new spices to food their Sentinel children already enjoy, rather than forcing them to try a completely foreign dish. Take them for a ride on the carousel, and then slowly introduce them to more intense rides. Entertainer parents who allow their Sentinel children to take their time trying new things are likely to discover them more trusting and willing partners in future adventures.

Entertainer Parent and an Explorer Child

An Adventurous and Independent Team

Naturally, Entertainer parents tend to find it easiest to communicate with their children if they belong to one of the Explorer types. Explorer children can be both adventurous and practical. They're often able to come up with exciting activities on their own if they're encouraged and given enough freedom to express themselves.

Their Explorer children's curiosity likely fascinates Entertainer parents. Even from a very young age, Explorer children are apt to feel in tune with the present moment and the world around them, finding enjoyment in things such as nature and sports, reflecting their parents' preferences. Outdoor activities are likely to form a large portion of Entertainer parents' repertoire.

Explorer children and Entertainer parents share the tendency to place a lot of importance on freedom and independence and often insist on being allowed to experiment and do things in their own way. Entertainers cherish seeing their curious, enthusiastic kids discover something new or exhaust themselves while spending hours on recently acquired hobbies.

Entertainer parents recognize their children's love of freedom. They may be reluctant to discipline them for overstepping boundaries in fear of suppressing what they feel might be the better parts of themselves that they see reflected in their kids. Such an improvisational and laid-back attitude can be a double-edged sword, though. Identifying deeply with their impulses, these parents may neglect to set firm enough limits for these children.

Missing the Bigger Picture

Tangentially, Entertainer parents may also have difficulties teaching their Explorer children to find time for introspection and personal development. All Explorers are far more interested in real, palpable matters than internal discussions or abstract ideas. They would far rather develop concrete skills with visible results. Both types of endeavor have value. But it's easy for Explorers to overlook the broader, far-reaching path of their lives when they always live in the moment.

Finally, as Entertainer parents focus more on improvisation and thinking on their feet, they tend to have difficulties with purely administrative and practical tasks. When unbalanced, this proclivity can lead to serious issues, especially in areas such as finance. Explorer kids are likely to share this weakness. Parents with this personality type should make conscious efforts to teach their Explorer children the importance of being economical, making fact-based decisions, and knowing how to combine that restless curiosity with more practical needs and responsibilities.

Considering the Future

It can be pleasant to live in the moment, but Entertainers do their Explorer children a disservice if they neglect to consider the future. Encouraging their Explorer kids to view life as a spontaneous adventure seems harmless enough, but when children lack direction or the ability to form a well-thought-out strategy, they can venture into some unsavory situations. Adults who accrue unmanageable debt or have continuous financial problems were often once children who didn't learn to plan well.

To prevent these potential long-term issues, Entertainer parents should be intentional about helping their children appreciate that their present actions affect their future. Children of all ages (even adolescents) aren't always capable of understanding the potential consequences of their behaviors. It's up to their parents to guide them until they develop that ability, and Entertainers do well to remember that their job as parents includes preparing their children to be adults.

As impulsive individuals themselves, Entertainers may want to explore how their lack of planning or direction may have affected their lives. Anecdotes about rash decisions they made as children *("I decided to try some beer at a friend's party my sophomore year in high school.")* and the negative outcomes that resulted from those decisions *("I got really sick, and my parents grounded me for two months when they found out.")* can effectively illustrate the importance of considering future consequences.

Conclusion

Balancing their refreshing spontaneity and somewhat *laissez-faire* attitude with the responsibilities that come with parenthood can be a challenge for Entertainer parents. But if they master the right approach, they not only raise children who are capable and responsible but they also manage to build in an element of whimsy and adventure. It doesn't matter what personality type their children turn out to be. Smart discipline and the teaching of responsibility paired with Entertainers' unique personality style can help their children experience the best of two worlds.

Responsible parents always adapt themselves, regardless of their own core inclinations, to raise their children compassionately and intelligently. If Entertainers see parenting as a skill to acquire and try to do so, they're likely to be marvelous, conscientious parents who open unique doors in sometimes unconventional ways.

Final Words

For Entertainers, it could be said that life without other people could hardly be considered life at all. Relationships are fundamental to their sense of well-being, which is why it is so important that their relationships are balanced and help them develop their full potential as individuals.

It's true that people with the Entertainer personality type may struggle to shift their relationships beyond the realm of the superficial. They often grapple with commitment and might fall into the trap of being more concerned with how a relationship looks than with how it functions at a deeper level. Combine these tendencies with a general sensitivity to criticism and a preference for making decisions through an emotional filter, and it's easy to see where many of the relationship challenges that Entertainers face spring from.

But Entertainers also have a lot to offer to the people they share relationships with. They are strongly rooted in the here and now and tend to let things go, moving on quickly from conflict. They are doers who take on challenges with as much flair as they have when organizing good times. And Entertainers love to share the beauty and pleasures of the world with the people they care about.

In these pages, we've discussed common tendencies that Entertainers bring to their romantic relationships, their friendships, and their roles as parents. Our hope is that these insights will equip Entertainers to establish true intimacy and those long-standing connections that bring substance to life and that grow more meaningful and rewarding with every passing year.

So... What's Next?

You've reached the end of this book, but fear not – we've created many more resources for you. Here are a few that might capture your interest:

- Want more tests and insights to help you build strong relationships? Explore our Relationships Specialized Tests.
- Looking to enhance your academic or professional life? Check out the *Entertainer Guide to Careers*.
- Ready to pursue personal growth and better understand your strengths and potential weaknesses? Our *Entertainer Guide to Personal Growth* may be just what you need.

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